

TB

TB DOTS means watching each patient take their medicine so that the treatment works. Community support is a big part of the cure.

For health workers

Key messages

- Ask about cough at every home visit. Refer anyone who has coughed for two weeks or more for testing.
- Support DOTS: help each patient take every dose, keep appointments and collect refills.
- Watch for side effects and missed doses and tell the health facility early.
- Screen household contacts, especially children.
- Reduce stigma. TB is curable, and patients need support from their family, not fear.

Refer straight away if a patient has

- Coughing blood
- Difficulty breathing
- Missed medicine for several days
- Serious side effects, such as yellow eyes or repeated vomiting
- A child in the household with a long cough or weight loss

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.